

Day 10: Formatting vs Content

Morning Post (Educational)

LinkedIn Post

That colorful, double-column Canva CV template is the reason you are getting automated rejections.

Many job seekers use graphic design templates with columns, icons, tables, and progress bars to make their CV stand out. They think it looks professional and modern.

ATS software cannot parse complex layouts. They read text from left to right and top to bottom. Columns scramble the reading order, making your experience look like gibberish to the system. If the machine cannot read it, you get rejected.

Use a simple, single-column format. Use standard fonts like Arial, Calibri, or Times New Roman. Avoid text boxes, tables, headers, footers, and progress bars. The simpler the layout, the easier it is for the system to read.

I've reviewed dozens of CVs, and clean, simple black-and-white formats consistently parse with 100% accuracy, while highly designed templates fail.

A CV is a business document, not a design portfolio. You can use AI to build clean, structured content that fits a simple layout.

If this sounds familiar, I'll be teaching the complete workflow inside my upcoming AI Job Seeker Workshop. Seats are limited.

Handwritten Visual

Handwritten Visual Text

"Simple layouts get parsed. Scrambled layouts get rejected."

AI Visual Prompt

Minimalist overhead photo of clean white paper. The sentence is handwritten neatly in thick black marker. Natural lighting. No hands. No notebook. No decorations. High contrast. Mobile friendly. Lots of white space. Instagram and LinkedIn optimized.

Repurposed Formats

LinkedIn Carousel

- **Slide 1:** Title: The Canva CV Trap.
- **Slide 2:** The Mistake: Using double columns, icons, and progress bars.
- **Slide 3:** The Issue: ATS parses columns horizontally, scrambling your career history.
- **Slide 4:** The Fix: Use a single-column, text-based Word document with zero graphics.
- **Slide 5:** Get the Template: AI Job Seeker Workshop. Workshop registration link: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

WhatsApp Status

- **Slide 1:** Colorful Canva CVs look nice to you, but they are unreadable to ATS software.
- **Slide 2:** Get my tested, ATS-safe CV template. Join the workshop. Workshop registration link:
<https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

Facebook Post

That colorful, double-column Canva CV template is the reason you are getting automated rejections.

ATS software cannot parse complex layouts. Columns scramble the text. Use a simple, single-column format in a standard font. Avoid tables, icons, and progress bars. I've reviewed dozens of CVs, and plain text formats consistently perform better.

Learn formatting rules and get my template at the AI Job Seeker Workshop. Workshop registration link:
<https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

X Thread

- 1/ That colorful, double-column Canva CV template is the reason you are getting automated rejections. Here's why. ■
- 2/ Job seekers think pretty templates stand out. But ATS software is blind to design.
- 3/ The software parses text from left to right. Columns scramble your contact details and job history.
- 4/ To the machine, your resume looks like a random puzzle of words.
- 5/ The fix: Use a single-column, clean layout. Standard fonts only. No tables, icons, or progress bars.
- 6/ I've reviewed dozens of CVs, and plain layouts consistently win more interviews.
- 7/ I'm sharing my ATS-safe template at the AI Job Seeker Workshop. Workshop registration link:
<https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

Afternoon Post (Story / Case Study)

LinkedIn Post

We changed her resume from a colorful graphic design template to a plain text format. Then she got three callbacks.

She was a talented Marketing Executive, but her CV was a double-column layout with circular skill progress bars (like "Creativity: 80%"). It looked beautiful, but it yielded zero interviews.

The ATS was unable to parse her contact details or job history because they were trapped inside decorative text boxes and sidebars.

We stripped the colors. We moved the content into a clean, single-column layout and replaced the arbitrary progress bars with actual achievement metrics. Within two weeks, she had three interview invites.

One of my clients got hired this week after we switched from a decorative template to an ATS-safe layout.

Your CV needs to be easy to read for the system first, then easy to read for the human recruiter.

If you're serious about improving your applications, I'll show the exact system during the workshop.

Handwritten Visual

Handwritten Visual Text

"CVs need readability, not decoration."

AI Visual Prompt

Minimalist overhead photo of clean white paper. The sentence is handwritten neatly in thick black marker. Natural lighting. No hands. No notebook. No decorations. High contrast. Mobile friendly. Lots of white space. Instagram and LinkedIn optimized.

Repurposed Formats

LinkedIn Carousel

- **Slide 1:** Title: 3 Callbacks from 1 Format Change.
- **Slide 2:** The Client: Marketing Executive with zero interviews.
- **Slide 3:** The Problem: Double-column template with skill progress bars that ATS couldn't read.
- **Slide 4:** The Solution: Stripped the design, moved to single-column, replaced bars with metrics.
- **Slide 5:** The Result: Passed the filters and got hired. Workshop details: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

WhatsApp Status

- **Slide 1:** My client's CV looked great, but it got zero callbacks because of text boxes.
- **Slide 2:** We simplified the format and she got hired this week. Join the workshop. Workshop registration link: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

Facebook Post

We changed her resume from a colorful graphic design template to a plain text format. Then she got three callbacks.

She was a Marketing Executive using a double-column layout with progress bars. The ATS couldn't parse it. We stripped the colors, used a single-column layout, and wrote achievements. One of my clients got hired this week after we made this change.

Stop letting design ruin your chances. Join the AI Job Seeker Workshop. Workshop registration link: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

X Thread

- 1/ We changed her resume from a colorful template to a plain text format. Then she got three callbacks. Here is the story. ■
- 2/ She was a talented Marketing Executive, but her CV was a complex double-column design.
- 3/ The ATS software scrambled her details because they were trapped in sidebars.
- 4/ We moved her experience into a clean, single-column layout. No colors, no icons.

5/ One of my clients got hired this week after we made this simple formatting shift.

6/ Your CV is a business document. Format it for system readability.

7/ Learn the formatting standards at the AI Job Seeker Workshop. Workshop registration link:
<https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

Evening Post (Workshop Invitation)

LinkedIn Post

Stop letting poor formatting hide your qualifications.

Many job seekers lose opportunities they are fully qualified for because their resume format is not technically compliant with modern systems.

The best format is clean, single-column, and text-based. I provide a pre-optimized template to all workshop participants.

I've worked with over 10 professionals to transition their resumes from fancy templates to high-performing, ATS-friendly structures.

Learn the exact layout rules and get the template I use for all my clients.

Workshop registration link: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

Handwritten Visual

Handwritten Visual Text

"Formatting should help you, not hide you."

AI Visual Prompt

Minimalist overhead photo of clean white paper. The sentence is handwritten neatly in thick black marker. Natural lighting. No hands. No notebook. No decorations. High contrast. Mobile friendly. Lots of white space. Instagram and LinkedIn optimized.

Repurposed Formats

LinkedIn Carousel

- **Slide 1:** Title: The ATS Template Guide.
- **Slide 2:** The Standard: Single-column, standard margins, simple headings.
- **Slide 3:** The Benefit: 100% parse rate on any modern ATS system.
- **Slide 4:** The Bonus: All workshop attendees get the exact template.
- **Slide 5:** Register: AI Job Seeker Workshop. Workshop registration link: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

WhatsApp Status

- **Slide 1:** Your formatting might be hiding your qualifications from recruiters.
- **Slide 2:** Get the exact ATS-safe template I use at the workshop. Workshop registration link:
<https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

Facebook Post

Stop letting poor formatting hide your qualifications.

Job seekers miss out on interviews because their CV format isn't technically compliant. The best format is clean, single-column, and text-based. I've worked with over 10 professionals to transition their resumes. Get my template.

AI Job Seeker Workshop registration link: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>

X Thread

- 1/ Stop letting poor formatting hide your qualifications. ■
- 2/ Many candidates are rejected by software before a human ever reads their resume.
- 3/ The solution is a clean, single-column, text-based layout.
- 4/ I've worked with over 10 professionals to clean up their resumes and get results.
- 5/ All workshop attendees receive the exact Word document template I use.
- 6/ Stop fighting the system. Use a format that works.
- 7/ AI Job Seeker Workshop registration link: <https://duncanmakoyo.com/#!/workshop>